

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-z1b-tkk5
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-5955

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

Despite what the alleged visionaries from places like Silicon Valley would have you believe, AI is looking to be the greatest boondoggle of the modern era, and one that will likely leech massively at government spending and/or private funding, whether it eventually works or not.

People like Sam Altman, eager to get their hands on funding from gullible investors and helpless taxpayers alike, will tell you two great lies when it comes to why AI is necessary.

1. AGI is right around the corner (We just need to feed our current models enough data stolen from the public and eventually literally all the problems in the world will be solved!)
2. The US needs to pour an unholy amount of capital into funding AI development or else China will beat us and then (???)

Now, let's address the flaws with both of these ideas.

1. What has been hyped up as "AI" over the last few years are systems called LLMs (Large Language Models) that have essentially been fed huge amounts of data and taught to sort it into meaningful output according to their training. Though described as "Machine Learning", these systems cannot think, and no amount of funding down the paths companies like Google or OpenAI wish to take will ever create anything like true AGI. (Source: https://www.reimagine-energy.ai/p/is-infinite-energy-all-we-need-to-utm_campaign=post&utm_medium=web)

In fact, LLMs have already plateaued greatly over the last two years and have not solved grievous errors that would support their use cases in everyday life. One problem with AI is that the companies working on them, despite the massive amount of money already given to them, have been unable to eliminate or even greatly improve the "hallucinations" causing LLMs to output completely incorrect and farcical data. (Source: <https://www.404media.co/ai-lawyer-hallucination-sanctions/>)

2. So what about China, then? Well the race there is already over as instead of behaving like US tech moguls who give vague promises of increasing functionality and usability in exchange for billions or, as Sam Altman thinks, trillions of dollars (Source: <https://www.wsj.com/tech/ai/sam-altman-seeks-trillions-of-dollars-to-reshape-business-of-chips-and-ai-89ab3db0>), the Chinese have already publicly released LLMs that might even be up to snuff with US models, and potentially even more efficient considering they only trained them using around six million in capital. (Source: <https://www.nbcnews.com/business/markets/tech-stocks-react-chinas-deepseek-sparks-us-worries-ai-race-rcna189394>)

With that said, what are we even trying to beat China at here? Building better fake super AIs that just output completely bogus information anyways?

To most Americans this will seem much more like an elaborate embezzling scheme as opposed to actual scientific progress, especially when comparing funding required by the Chinese for AI development to that being begged for by American CEOs and tech spokespeople. I thought this entire administration wanted to cut the fat off of this kind of spending, so why can't these companies do more

with less themselves?

As for regulation, I believe that AI is one of the places where more guardrails are desperately needed in order to avert economic catastrophe. The disregard for moral imperative when it comes to these companies stealing data from artists, writers, coders, and many other professionals, and then using said data to churn out cheap rubbish to put these same people out of work is alarming, to say the least. I'm sure talking about the ethics of such things is going to fall on deaf ears, but what's going to happen when these people are unemployed because others are churning out cheap (And honestly, horrible) generative AI writing, design work, and coding at ten times the pace? Do we really want to live in a world filled with soulless culture created at the press of a button and an even greater unemployment rate than that of the Great Depression? (Source: <https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-65102150>)

Technologists would have you believe that new jobs will pop up to replace those lost, but then refuse to elaborate on just how that will be the case.

Without regulation, LLMs and other Generative AI models are set to completely upend the economy as we know it; theft of intellectual property and automating away entire swathes of the corporate sector are just the tip of the iceberg when it comes to potential problems that we will see. Those in support of AI promise (And promise, and promise again!) that we'll all be treated to a grand utopia when we finally reach an alleged AGI-based "Singularity", but all I see is a race to the bottom as the economy crashes while the great and the good fuel the fire with money better spent to any other purpose than feeding the bottomless demands of Silicon Valley. Is that really what this administration wishes to be remembered for?